



PROGRESS REPORT

West Africa: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-04-2 · 74 systems and instruments tracked

Compiled 2026-09-04 by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository. Sections run from the region's institutions outwards to what funds them. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · INSTITUTIONS AND MANDATES · INSTRUMENTS AND HARMONISATION ·
SHARED SYSTEMS AND INFRASTRUCTURE · COORDINATION AND COLLABORATION · CAPACITY AND INCLUSION · FINANCE
· WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Of 74 bodies, instruments and systems on this place's ledger, 49 changed position between 2025-09-01 and 2026-09-04, 5 did not, 19 carry no stated baseline, and 1 is **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 147 sources for this place in the window – 31 in the earlier half (2025-09 to 2026-02), 116 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* – a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* – a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* – an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* – the programme ended. *No change* – the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* – the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

On 2026-07-19 at Lungi the ECOWAS Authority [adopted a Revised Supplementary Act on the Protection of Personal Data](#), superseding the Act of February 2010, welcomed Council instruments on open data, electronic communications, digital governance and roaming, and approved a Regional Cybersecurity Coordination Mechanism. None of those texts is published with the communiqué.

PI-SPI, the union's instant-payment rail, [reached 30 million connected users](#) by 2026-07-20 on 80 connected institutions against 45 at launch, and the BCEAO [extended the connection deadline](#) it had set for 30 June 2026. The confederal credentials of the three states that left the bloc are meanwhile being issued, on specifications [unpublished since 2024-11-22](#).

Institutions and mandates

Regional collaboration

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
Alliance of Sahel States (AES)	A common biometric passport launched in January 2025; harmonised document specifications validated but unpublished; no confederal card issued	Both confederal credentials issuing, a cross-border enrolment run on another member's soil, and a national data centre offered as mutualised AES infrastructure	ADVANCED
BCEAO (Banque Centrale des Etats de l'Afrique de l'Ouest)	Operating the SICA and STAR systems, with the instant-payment platform in test phase	Operating the union's instant-payment rail, participating in the ECOWAS payment project and preparing a pilot accession to the continental one	ADVANCED
Cotonou Declaration on digital transformation in West and Central Africa	Did not exist	Adopted by West and Central African states, committing to a single digital market by 2030; no implementation report, work plan or secretariat held in the nine months since	ADVANCED
Draft Directive Governing Electronic Communications in West Africa	Did not exist	A three-day validation workshop advanced the draft directive toward ministerial approval; no adopted text, ministerial date or transposition deadline is published	ADVANCED
ECOWAS	Vision 2050 in force; the Supplementary Act of February 2010 the newest regional digital instrument the base held	a new president of the commission in office from 31 August 2026	ADVANCED
ECOWAS project-preparation pipeline for digital connectivity	Did not exist	Digital connectivity placed alongside transport, energy and water in the pipeline for development finance and private investment; no project list, envelope or first report held	ADVANCED
ECOWAS regional postal-sector regulatory framework	The 2016 postal-sector Directive in force, with no revision on record	Officials from ten member states, meeting the Commission's digital economy and post directorate with the regional infrastructure preparation unit, the Pan-African Postal Union and the West African postal operators' body at Lome on 12-13 August 2026, validated the orientations of a revised Directive and the outline of a Regional Postal Master Plan 2027-2030, naming digital transformation, e-commerce, universal-service modernisation, consumer protection and financial inclusion as priority areas; consultations with member states on the revised Directive continue and neither text is published	ADVANCED
WATRA (West Africa Telecommunications Regulators Assembly)	Working groups established about two years earlier, with no technical output on record	Five technical reports finalised, a 23rd general assembly held at Lome, and a regional position stated on submarine-cable resilience	ADVANCED

Public debate and participation in policymaking

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
Regional Feminist Data Agenda 2026-2028	Did not exist	Ratified with three priorities for 2026-2028, each carrying a named owner, alongside eight thematic policy briefs and a cross-border encrypted data collective with rapid-response protocols; no text is published	ADVANCED

The Regional Cybersecurity Coordination Mechanism the Authority [approved on 2026-07-19](#) is a body rather than a declaration, and the base holds nothing else on it: no terms of reference, seat, budget or staffing.

WATRA closed a two-year working-group cycle at Ouagadougou on 2026-04-12, [finalising five technical reports](#) on 5G deployment, submarine-cable resilience, cybersecurity frameworks, consumer protection and non-geostationary satellite regulation, which executive secretary Aliyu Yusuf Aboki called a shift from dialogue to the delivery of regulatory tools. None of the five is held here.

The Alliance of Sahel States, which severed its ECOWAS ties in 2024, is building a parallel layer. Niger's prime minister [enrolled for the AES passport on 2026-07-16](#); Burkina Faso [enrolled its residents in Mali](#) in June 2026, a first on another member's soil; and Mali's data centre was [offered in the short term as mutualised AES infrastructure](#).

Instruments and harmonisation

Strategies, plans and policies

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
BCEAO regulatory approach to cryptoassets	No recognition of cryptoassets as legal tender and repeated warnings to users, with no regulatory work under way	The central bank opened a structured process across 2025 and 2026: a questionnaire sent to fintech operators, a dedicated committee named C-CRYPTO, and a high-level international conference in May 2026. Cryptoassets remain outside legal tender and no instrument has been issued; the legal framework is described as still incomplete, and the question the bank has set itself is how to admit the instruments without compromising monetary stability, the issuance monopoly of the CFA franc and the integrity of the regional financial system	ADVANCED
ECOWAS Regional Digital Single Market roadmap	Did not exist	Adopted as a commitment to harmonise policy across interoperable fintech, unified digital ID and rural broadband; no work programme, timetable or budget held	ADVANCED
WATRA technical reports on 5G, submarine-cable resilience, cybersecurity, consumer protection and NGSO	None published	Seven documents published: the cybersecurity working group's final report, the infrastructure working group's 2023-2025 report covering 5G, NGSO, cable resilience and WRC-27, the 5G deployment and policy framework, the submarine-cable resilience recommendations, the consumer access and experience regulatory synthesis and two of its seven constituent guidelines	ADVANCED
ECOWAS Digital Sector Development Strategy 2024-2029	Adopted October 2024, text unpublished	Still unpublished, so its targets, budget and implementation arrangements are unestablished; the roaming implementation progress report and the directive on cyber confidence-building measures adopted alongside it are unpublished too	NO CHANGE

Legislation and regulation

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
Cybercrime statutes in the Sahel states	BASELINE NOT HELD	A press-freedom organisation reports the cybercrime statutes of Burkina Faso, Mali, Niger and Guinea being used to prosecute journalists, and calls for the repeal of vague public-order and human-dignity provisions	<i>Baseline not held</i>
ECOWAS Supplementary Act A/SA.2/01/10 on Electronic Transactions	Not held	The community's own act on electronic transactions, adopted alongside the companion act on personal-data protection this ledger holds separately; the full text is now held	BASELINE NOT HELD

Data protection

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
ECOWAS Supplementary Act on the Protection of Personal Data	The Supplementary Act of February 2010, the regional benchmark national bills were still being drafted against	A revised Act adopted; its text is not published with the communique, so what changed against 2010 is not establishable from the base; the complete text is now held, adopted at the thirty-seventh session of the Authority of Heads of State and Government in Abuja on 16 February 2010	ADVANCED

Standards

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
Alliance ouest-africaine des noms de domaine (AOAN)	Did not exist	Announced as an initiative to coordinate country-code domain policy across the region; no charter, membership or founding act held	ADVANCED
ECOWAS free-roaming regulation C/REG.21/12/17	In force since December 2017, implemented between Liberia, The Gambia and Sierra Leone (2025-02), with full implementation by all mobile operators due by end-2025	A second three-state arrangement live, giving free incoming calls for up to 30 days and local rates on outgoing traffic; the end-2025 deadline passed with six of fifteen member states covered	ADVANCED, AGAINST A MISSED END-2025 DEADLINE
National accounting councils required of member states	The obligation standing with the newest member state's council not established	In force since 1997 and requiring each member state to establish a national accounting council; one member state launched its own in August 2026, twenty-nine years on	ADVANCED
Regional certified electronic signature	Did not exist	The Commission has set out a programme towards a certified electronic signature usable across West Africa; no standard, root authority or member-state adoption is on file	ADVANCED
AES harmonised specifications for travel and identity documents	Validated and referred to the heads of state; no approval, gazetted text or reference number	Unchanged, while both credentials built on them are issued; no published text located	NO CHANGE

AI

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
ECOWAS Regional AI Governance Framework	Did not exist	Resolved to be developed, citing algorithmic bias, labour displacement and information disorder; no draft, drafting body or date held in the six months since; a four-country comparative study presented on 2026-08-10 found none of Benin, Senegal, Cote d'Ivoire or Burkina Faso holds AI-specific legislation in force or in draft, rating Cote d'Ivoire's strategy the most advanced of the four on inclusion and data governance and finding Burkina Faso's data-protection law the only one to name AI-based processing	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
Francophone West African AI governance guidelines	Did not exist	Adopted by Benin, Burkina Faso, Cote d'Ivoire, Guinea, Mali and Senegal; advisory, complementing national strategies rather than replacing them	ADVANCED

The Revised Supplementary Act on the Protection of Personal Data [was adopted on 2026-07-19](#) on the Council of Ministers' recommendation, replacing the Act of February 2010 against which national bills across the region have been drafted. The communiqué neither reproduces nor summarises it and the base holds neither instrument, so the supersession can be recorded and its content cannot.

Two AI instruments sit at different stages. ECOWAS [resolved in January 2026](#) to develop a regional framework, and no draft is held six months on. Outside the bloc's machinery, six states — three of them AES members — [adopted shared AI governance guidelines on 2026-07-06](#), convened by the advocacy organisation Niyel and advisory rather than binding.

Harmonisation moved furthest where an instrument had operational consequences. The directors-general of the national statistical institutes [approved methodological guides](#) for the industrial production index, the business register and public debt statistics at Dakar on 2026-07-31. Under the roaming regulation of December 2017, Senegal, Togo and Benin [brought a free-roaming arrangement into effect at Lomé on 2026-04-24](#): free incoming calls for up to 30 consecutive days, local rates on outgoing traffic.

The BCEAO's connection obligation slipped. Interoperability [was to be mandatory from 30 June 2026](#); the central bank then [set 30 September 2026 for banks, e-money issuers and payment institutions and 30 June 2027 for microfinance institutions](#).

Shared systems and infrastructure

Connectivity

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
CSquared West Africa backbone	Carrying regional traffic on its own subsea and terrestrial routes	Capacity on the 2Africa West system added for route diversity, after three multi-country outages in 28 months at the Accra, Lagos and Abidjan landing concentration	ADVANCED
ECOWAS second submarine cable (Cabo Verde, Liberia, Sierra Leone, Guinea-Bissau)	Did not exist	Member-state experts with technical and financial partners reviewed and approved the feasibility study for a second submarine cable serving four member states, at a workshop organised by the community's project preparation and development unit; the stated aims are better integration of Cabo Verde with the region, more international capacity and route redundancy, and no route, cost, landing site or construction date is published	ADVANCED
EllaLink Mauritania branch	Launched at Nouadhibou in July 2025, with nothing laid	Coastal landing complete, offshore laying scheduled for August 2026 and commissioning expected in the first quarter of 2027	ADVANCED
Via Africa submarine cable	Did not exist	A consortium memorandum signed by Canalink, GUILAB, International Mauritania Telecom, the Orange group, Sonatel and Silverlinks for a Europe-to-South-Africa system landing in Mauritania, Senegal, Guinea, Cote d'Ivoire and Nigeria; no cost, contract or in-service date held	ADVANCED
West Africa Peering Forum	Did not exist	The 2026 forum drew 281 participants from 23 countries for technical sessions on exchange-point and peering development; the published report records the host country's own exchange point still carrying under 1 Gbps of traffic after nearly ten years, alongside a newly announced second national exchange point with five connected members	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
Nigeria-Burkina Faso connectivity partnership	Did not exist	Technical teams to assess routes through Niger and through Benin, on a stated aim of halving the cost of internet access in Burkina Faso	BASELINE NOT HELD
WACS cable repair logistics	BASELINE NOT HELD	The cable's spare-fibre depot sits at Brest, far from the stretch between Senegal and Congo where most outages occur, so a repair ship had to sail from Portland to Abidjan	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Data Storage

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
Data-centre capacity gap	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 150MW to 200MW of new capacity – 30 or more large-scale facilities – needed to reach the capacity-to-population ratio of a moderately mature market such as Morocco, on a regional depth of 0.04MW per million people; as at early 2025 the region was the only one on the continent with no established or announced public cloud region from any of the world's five largest cloud providers	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Cybersecurity

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
ECOWAS Regional Cybersecurity Coordination Mechanism	Did not exist	Establishment approved; no terms of reference, seat, budget or staffing held	ADVANCED
Regional organised-crime operation	Under way	An eight-month international police operation targeting West African organised crime groups concluded with 58 arrests	CLOSED
ECOWAS Directive C/DIR.1/08/11 on Fighting Cyber Crime	Not held	The community's own cybercrime directive, the instrument the member states' national cybercrime statutes are made against; the full text is held, recovered by optical character recognition from an image-only scan	BASELINE NOT HELD
ECOWAS Information Sharing and Analysis Centre	BASELINE NOT HELD	Named by the Commission as established, as the region's threat-intelligence sharing platform; no founding instrument, membership, feed or published output is held (2026-08)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Data Exchange

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
SIGMAT (ECOWAS interconnected transit management system)	Operating on major corridors since 2019	A forward roadmap presented to the World Customs Organization and deployment agreed at three further border posts; the e-Hub and the regional guarantee system remain roadmap items	ADVANCED, MARGINAL

Digital Identity and CRVS

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
AES biometric passport	Launched in January 2025, with no state-by-state issuance on record	Issuing in all three states, with Mali's supplied by China's Emptech in place of France's Idemia	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
CIB-AES (AES biometric identity card)	Did not exist	Issuing in Burkina Faso since December 2025 and in Niger since March 2026, with mass enrolment under way and cross-border enrolment tested in Mali	ADVANCED
ENBIC (ECOWAS National Biometric Identity Card)	Operationalised by six member states, with no rollout held in the largest	Rolled out by Nigeria in November 2025 and deployed in the field in Guinea-Bissau under a cross-border traders' project	ADVANCED
UEMOA customer identification and verification instruction (003-03-2025)	Did not exist in this form	In force since March 2025: how financial institutions must identify customers, verify identity and know their clientele across the monetary union	ADVANCED
WURI (West Africa Unique Identification for Regional Integration and Inclusion)	Phase 2 running to a closing date of 30 July 2026, with no interoperability strategy validated	A cross-border interoperability and mutual-recognition strategy validated and a 2026 work plan adopted; the phase's stated closing date has passed with no completion, extension or successor record held	ADVANCED

Digital Payments and Fintech

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
BCEAO connection obligation for instant-payment participants	Interoperability announced as mandatory from 30 June 2026	Banks, e-money issuers and payment institutions have until 30 September 2026 and microfinance institutions until 30 June 2027	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
Institutions connected to PI-SPI	45 at launch (2025-09-30)	104 authorised at 31 July 2026, against 80 connected at 24 June 2026 and 74 at the end of December 2025, with Senegal (24) and Cote d'Ivoire (23) holding nearly half, ahead of Mali (14), Burkina Faso (13), Benin (11), Togo (9) and Guinea-Bissau and Niger (5 each)	ADVANCED
Institutions issuing electronic money in the UEMOA	63 institutions (2024-12-31), 14 of them licensed electronic money issuers	78 institutions at 31 December 2025 against 63 a year earlier - 59 banks in partnership with telecommunications operators or technical providers, 18 licensed electronic money issuers, one microfinance institution, and four national treasuries also issuing. The licensed issuers rose from 14 to 18 on approvals for Djogana Pay (Cote d'Ivoire), QuickPay SA and TouchPoint Financial Services (Senegal) and Tmoney (Togo), concentrated in Senegal (5) and Cote d'Ivoire (4). Provisional data on the 17 active issuers put turnover at FCFA 323.2bn, up 12%, outstanding electronic money at FCFA 1,923.2bn, up 35.2%, and profit at FCFA 16.9bn after FCFA 6.1bn in 2024	ADVANCED
PI-SPI (UEMOA interoperable instant-payment platform)	In live testing from August 2025, ahead of a launch set for 30 September 2025	In service across the eight member states, free for person-to-person transfers, with banks and mobile money interconnected since May 2026	ADVANCED
Users connected to PI-SPI	Did not exist	30 million connected users and one million transactions worth 110 billion FCFA in under ten months	ADVANCED
BCEAO guide to digitalising member-state payments	In force	In force, unrevised on the record	NO CHANGE
UEMOA electronic-money issuer instruction (008-05-2015)	In force since 2015	In force since 2015: the conditions and procedures under which electronic-money issuers may operate in the member states of the monetary union	NO CHANGE
BCEAO accession to the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System	BASELINE NOT HELD	A six-month pilot with more than 80 commercial banks is planned before any decision, to test conformity with the union's external-financial-relations rules	Baseline not held

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
BCEAO Instruction 001-03-2021 on oversight of payment infrastructures	Not held	Defines the central bank's governance and oversight role over financial market infrastructures, payment instruments and payment-service providers across the eight member states: classification of systemically important infrastructures, risk-based surveillance principles, reporting obligations, and the corrective measures and sanctions the bank may impose	BASELINE NOT HELD
EPSS (ECOWAS Payment and Settlement System)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Work is on where the platform's components will be hosted and on evaluating the central banks bidding to host them; no build, cost, timetable or legal instrument held	<i>Baseline not held</i>
GIM-UEMOA interbank switch	BASELINE NOT HELD	The regional interbank electronic-payments switch is running under an interim chief executive, its previous director-general having left the post he held from March 2020	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Payment institutions licensed in the monetary union	Baseline not held	Thirty-one structures licensed as payment institutions across the union under the 2024 payment-services instruction, eleven of them in Senegal and nine in Cote d'Ivoire	BASELINE NOT HELD
UEMOA Regulation 15/2002/CM on payment systems	Not held	The founding regional act for payment systems across the monetary union: it sets the legal basis for electronic signatures and certification, makes bank account access mandatory, promotes scriptural payment instruments, and governs netting, settlement finality and the cheque regime - the frame under which the union's later instant-payment and electronic-money instruments sit	BASELINE NOT HELD
Union instruction on payment services	BASELINE NOT HELD	The union-wide regulatory instrument for payment services, made under the monetary union treaty and the uniform banking, microfinance and anti-money-laundering laws, governing payment services including electronic-money institutions and mobile payment services	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Sectoral management information systems

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
ASRII Digital Platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	Twenty core participants trained across the Commission's directorates with the Directorate of Research and Statistics named as single focal point; the platform is to replace manual collection with submission, validation, automated computation of integration scores and dissemination, and is to be used to evaluate member states' policy implementation and track commitments across sectors. No integration score has been published (2026-08)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Other GovTech and e-Gov

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
Strengthening Tax Administration Capacity Project	Did not exist	A regional tax administration forum project financed by a US\$5.52m grant from a development fund's transition support facility, with implementation running to 30 July 2030 under a forum-hosted project implementation unit and a multi-stakeholder steering committee	ADVANCED

National statistics

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
ECOWAS regional statistical methodological guides	The Regional Statistical Programme 2023-2027 under implementation, with no adopted methodological guide held	Regional methodological guides in use, with a second Abidjan workshop training national coordination and economic policy committee members to operationalise the common regional frameworks for compiling and publishing macroeconomic statistics, reviewing the two regional databases and the harmonisation of member states' 2000-2025 national statistics for multilateral surveillance	ADVANCED
Migration and macroeconomic data harmonisation	Did not exist	Two regional statistics workshops convened at Abidjan on 18-22 August 2026 under the Commission's research and statistics directorate and its harmonisation project: the sixth Regional Coordination Meeting, which reviewed and validated the third edition of the Regional Report on International Migration in West Africa, and a capacity-building session for national committees on compiling macroeconomic statistics for the Convergence and Macroeconomic Stability Pact; participants also took up updates to the regional macroeconomic and statistical databases and harmonisation of national series for 2000-2025	ADVANCED
ECOMAC (ECOWAS Multilateral Surveillance Mechanism database)	Baseline not held	The database of the bloc's multilateral surveillance mechanism, constituted by a statistical and computer protocol adopted by the Council of Ministers in December 2007: thirteen Excel tables on a quarterly update cadence with stated deadlines, and supervision divided between the monetary union's commission and central bank, the West African Monetary Agency and the West African Monetary Institute; no later amendment and no operational report is held	BASELINE NOT HELD

PI-SPI carried the region's clearest movement. Launched across the eight member states on 2025-09-30, it [reported 30 million connected users and one million transactions worth 110 billion FCFA](#) at 2026-07-20. The BCEAO calls that uptake gradual: 80 institutions are connected against 74 at the end of December 2025 and 45 at launch, and states that the pace of new connections has slowed sharply. A later count on a different base — institutions authorised rather than connected — [puts 104 across the union at 31 July 2026, with Senegal on 24 and Côte d'Ivoire on 23 holding nearly half of them](#), ahead of Mali on 14, Burkina Faso on 13, Benin on 11, Togo on 9 and Guinea-Bissau and Niger on 5 each. Beneath it sit [248,710,918 open e-money accounts](#) at 2024-12-31, against 209,025,380 a year earlier.

The issuer layer underneath grew faster than the rail. The union's banking commission counts [78 institutions offering electronic money at the end of 2025 against 63 a year earlier](#), the licensed issuers among them rising from 14 to 18 and spread unevenly, and provisional turnover across seventeen active issuers at FCFA 323.2bn, up 12%. Two cross-border tracks opened above the union rail, neither with an earlier position in the base. The BCEAO is [participating in the ECOWAS Payment and Settlement System](#), where work is on hosting criteria and on the central banks bidding to host the platform's components, and is preparing accession to the continental system through a six-month pilot with more than 80 commercial banks.

Identity credentials advanced on both sides of the region's split. Nigeria [issued the ECOWAS biometric card from November 2025](#), and Niger [began mass enrolment for the confederal card](#) and Mali's passport [passed from France's Idemia to China's Emptech](#) after a data-transfer dispute.

Capacity added to the region was commercial. CSquared [added 2Africa West capacity to its own network](#) after three multi-country outages in 28 months at the Accra, Lagos and Abidjan landing concentration. A consortium of Canalink, GUILAB, International Mauritania Telecom, Orange, Sonatel and Silverlinks [signed a memorandum on 2026-05-13](#) for the Via Africa system, with no cost or in-service date on record; Mauritania's second cable [completed its coastal landing on 2026-05-04](#).

Coordination and collaboration

Innovation ecosystem

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
ECOWAS Startup Awards	Baseline not held	A second edition launched by the Commission's private sector and industry directorate, offering scaling technology-led businesses managerial training, venture funding and cross-border expansion support within the continental free trade area; no prize fund, entry deadline, cohort size or outcome from the first edition is published	ADVANCED

China activities

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
China-aid ECOWAS Headquarters Building	BASELINE NOT HELD	Handed over to the Commission, the second international-organisation office complex China has built in Africa; China describes cooperation extending into the digital economy and names no digital programme, figure or instrument, and the Commission's own release names no digital component	Baseline not held

WURI, run by the World Bank with the ECOWAS Commission as co-secretariat, is the region's longest-running joint programme. An interoperability and mutual-recognition strategy for foundational identity [was validated at Accra](#) in August 2025 and again [by the second supervisory committee, with a 2026 work plan](#). Phase 2 [carries a closing date of 30 July 2026](#); that date has passed with no completion, extension or successor record held, and two of its four states have left ECOWAS.

West and Central African states [adopted the Cotonou Declaration on 2025-11-18](#), committing to an integrated digital market by 2030; nine months on, no implementation report, work plan or secretariat is held. The period's one new structure was proposed by practitioners rather than institutions: an alliance of domain-name professionals, [put to the SIPEN-UEMOA salon](#) in July 2026.

Capacity and inclusion

Training and skills

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
BCEAO/COFEB certifying programme in digital finance	Baseline not held	In its fourth edition, run by the monetary union's central bank training centre with Luxembourg's House of Training-ATTF: four modules over about nine months and 84 hours, aimed at senior staff of credit institutions, e-money issuers and microfinance institutions, one candidate per institution, participation fees of FCFA 1.2m, an 80% pass mark per module and a final project defended before a jury at Dakar	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
Cybersecurity professionals certified as SIM3 auditors	Did not exist	38 professionals from member states and partner institutions trained at Lomé, 4 to 6 August 2026, to assess the maturity of national computer security incident response teams (2026-08)	ADVANCED
EU-ECOWAS EPSG support for fact-checking platforms	BASELINE NOT HELD	Two Nigerian organisations selected for in-kind technical support covering digital infrastructure, cybersecurity and verification systems, with training in AI, digital investigations and deepfake detection, and admission to a regional cross-border verification network; no amount, duration or start date is stated	Baseline not held

Access to services

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
Open e-money accounts in the UEMOA	209,025,380 accounts (2023)	248,710,918 accounts (2024-12-31), of which 76,863,533 active, an activity rate of 30.9%	ADVANCED

Capacity work in the window is too small, dated interventions rather than a programme. Thirty-eight professionals from member states and partner institutions were trained at Lomé between 4 and 6 August to assess the maturity of national incident response teams – auditors for a maturity model, which is capacity to measure capacity rather than to operate. Separately two Nigerian organisations were selected for in-kind technical support covering digital infrastructure, cybersecurity and verification systems, with training in artificial intelligence, digital investigations and deepfake detection, and admission to a regional cross-border verification network; no amount, duration or start date is stated.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
ECOWAS Community Budget provision for digital programmes	No disaggregated digital or ICT line, and nil actual on the Youth Entrepreneurship in ICT line since 2023	The 2026-2028 MTEF carries no disaggregated digital or ICT line; Youth Entrepreneurship in ICT is nil from 2024 through the 2028 estimates, against UA 543,953 approved and UA 407,965 actual in 2022	NO CHANGE

New investments

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
Africa Connect Digital Campus	Did not exist	A EUR 4.2m European Union and French foreign ministry project to upgrade broadband connectivity, e-learning and national research and education networks at universities in Benin, Cote d'Ivoire and Togo under the Global Gateway strategy; no university list, bandwidth target or delivery milestone is published	ADVANCED
Co-investment in Coris Bank International	Did not exist	A EUR 100m co-investment led by a private equity manager alongside four development finance institutions into the union's second-largest banking group; the amount is not broken out by country and no digital or financial-inclusion use of proceeds is stated	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-04	MOVEMENT
Digital Transformation Fund (BOAD/KfW)	Did not exist	A joint fund of the West African Development Bank and the German development bank carrying an envelope of 71 billion FCFA for digital modernisation of public administrations across the eight monetary-union states, with a published six-step instruction and validation process, a named focal point in each member state, and eligibility terms of a maximum 24-month project, a budget ceiling of 2,500 million FCFA, an interest rate the fund states at 2.2% and obligatory partial state co-financing; no date of signature or entry into force, no country allocation and no committed or disbursed total is published	ADVANCED
WARDIP (Western Africa Regional Digital Integration Program)	The first series alone: US\$293.00m across four states, ECOWAS, the African Union and Smart Africa	A second series approved on 2026-03-11 for Benin, Liberia and Sierra Leone, with Liberia's US\$50m share signed in June	ADVANCED
World Bank commitment to the WARDIP series	US\$293.00m, the first series (2023-11-07)	US\$430.00m across the two series, after US\$137.00m was approved on 2026-03-11	ADVANCED
Pooled equity investment in a pan-African start-up fund	Baseline not held	EUR10.5m approved toward first close - EUR7m from the continental development bank and EUR3.5m from the European Union with the African, Caribbean and Pacific states - into a fund investing in agribusiness, financial services, energy, education and health, mainly in Francophone West Africa	BASELINE NOT HELD

The regional layer's financing is a lender's. WARDIP's first series committed US\$293.00m; a second series of US\$137.00m was approved on 2026-03-11 for Benin, Liberia and Sierra Leone, taking the World Bank's commitment to US\$430.00m; Liberia signed its US\$50m share on 2026-06-08.

The central bank also opened the question it had held closed: having refused cryptoassets legal tender, it ran a questionnaire to fintech operators, established a C-CRYPTO committee and held an international conference in May 2026, with no instrument yet issued. The bloc's own contribution is procedural: the Authority directed the Commission to prioritise digital connectivity alongside transport, energy and water in its project-preparation pipeline. No project list, envelope or first report is held, nor any budget line of ECOWAS, the UEMOA Commission or WATRA for their own digital work, so what the region spends on the layer above cannot be stated at either end of the period.

Equity is the one instrument that moved on its own account. On 9 August the continental development bank approved a EUR10.5m pooled investment toward the first close of a pan-African start-up fund, EUR7m of it its own and EUR3.5m from the European Union with the African, Caribbean and Pacific states, aimed at agribusiness, financial services, energy, education and health mainly in Francophone West Africa. It is a fund commitment rather than a project one: what it buys will be visible only in the companies it later backs.

Where the record is thin

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
ECOWAS Statistical Policy and Regional Statistical Programme 2023-2027	The policy and programme the July 2026 meeting was implementing, and the methodological guides it approved; probed 2026-08-05: neither located as a document; what was found is the World Bank statistics operation financing the work and a 2002-era secretariat programme	2026-08-05

Six named objects carry no position at either end, and each was searched on 2026-08-05. Four searches returned published documents the base does not hold: the region's own digital sector strategy for 2024-2029, the community budget for 2026-2028, WATRA's technical reports, and a headquarters complex China financed for the ECOWAS Commission. These are gaps in this record rather than in the region's activity; acquisition lines have been raised, and none is cited above.

Two returned nothing: no regional digital skills programme of ECOWAS, the UEMOA Commission or WATRA, only single events; and neither the statistical policy nor the regional statistical programme the July 2026 meeting was implementing, only the World Bank operation financing that work.

The searches expose the report's own pattern: almost every instrument here is visible through a member state, a central bank, an operator or a press account of a meeting, and almost none through a publication of the body that made it. The communiqué of 2026-07-19 names five instruments adopted and reproduces none; the AES specifications have carried two credentials since 2024-11-22 without being published.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-09-04-2
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/XWA/XWA-progress.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/XWA/XWA-progress-2026-09-04-2.pdf
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0

Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.